

music

Notes of Ecstasy



SHAFQAT AMANAT ALI
Music Today
Rs 199

When music composer Shankar Mahadevan heard *Ankhon ke sagar*, a

number being aired on FM, he was so impressed that he called the radio station to find out who the singer was. Having learnt that it was Shafqat Amanat Ali Khan, the next thing he did was sign him for *Kabhi Alvida Na Kehna*. The song *Mitwa* turned out to be a huge hit. Much of the success lay in Khan's command over the classical idiom and modern music, matched only by the uniqueness of his voice.

After rendering the song *Yeh hausla* in Nagesh Kukunoor's *Dor*, Khan has come up with a solo album *Tabeer*, where he embarks on a creative journey, donning the role of a composer even as he lends his voice to his work. This nine-track album, released by Music Today, has some soul-stirring music. *Tabeer*

is a contemporary mix of earthy and traditional tones that gives the listener an unexplored freshness. With commendable ease, each track transports the listener to different moods. "I like to compose using ragas because that is my base and my foundation," says Khan.

"His music has moments of ecstasy, pain and pathos which are reflected in his voice. This is a rare gift," says Mahadevan. Khan is the son of singing maestro Ustad Amanat Ali Khan, which makes him part of the ninth generation of the Patiala Gharana. Since the age of four he has been learning Hindustani classical music, his grandmother being his first teacher. Khan will be performing in three cities to promote his album. So be there to capture the magic. In Delhi on September 17 at the Siri Fort Auditorium; in Mumbai on September 20 at the ITC Grand Central and in Kolkata on September 22 at the ICCR Auditorium.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

ZINGY SINGER: Khan embarks on a new journey



theatre

Clowning Glory

MUMBAI From the most famous mime artiste in the world, Marcel Marceau, to the most celebrated funny-man in the history of cinema Charlie Chaplin, clowning and clowns have always been an important part of stage, cinema and life. It was these very clowns that theatre and film director Rajat Kapoor intended to pay a tribute to with his very popular and critically acclaimed play *C for Clown*. Today, more than a 100 shows later, Kapoor is ready with a sequel, with a clown's take on the greatest plays of all times—Shakespeare's *Hamlet*. Titled *Hamlet—The Clown Prince*, the performance will be set in a similar environment of a circus and clowns will take on the characters of Hamlet, Claudius, Polonius and Ophelia, as the story of a tragedy-struck prince unfolds again largely through gibberish. The play has a bunch of fresh faces, all from the Mumbai theatre circuit. From September 16 to September 28. At Prithvi Theatres. by Nirmala Ravindran

JOKES APART: A still from the play



exhibition

Creative Upshot

MUMBAI Bollywood, the Raj legacy and classical Hindu goddesses find space on gallery walls as Manchester-based artist, Stephen Dixon, exhibits his collection titled *Embodied Narratives*. The collection includes Dixon's response to Mumbai in the form of his photographs, and a drawing made directly on the gallery walls. "As a maker of 'things', I regard my drawings on



A work by Dixon

paper and ceramics as crucial components of a visual laboratory," says Dixon. This is the first of four international residencies that the gallery will host. At The Loft from September 18.

by Swati Mathur